

Dylan M. Kennedy

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EDUCATION

University of South Carolina Honors College

Bachelor of Science in Chemical Engineering

May 2027

GPA: 3.89

Awards: Dean's Award, Barnhill Family Honorary Scholarship, Joseph H. Gibbons Engineering Scholarship

EXPERIENCE

Enviva Biomass – Greenwood, SC

May 2026 – August 2026

Engineering and Operations Intern

- Built a cost model in Excel scoping a chemical additive to eliminate Wet Electrostatic Precipitator (WESP) cleaning downtime, projecting ~\$100K in annual savings.
- Analyzed P&IDs and real-time plant data to quantify WESP inefficiencies, translating chemical process losses into measurable operating-cost.
- Presented the project and additive recommendation to the corporate executive team, including the CEO; proposal was well received and entered the capital funding process.
- Performed Root Cause Analysis on open-ended manufacturing problems and applied data-driven troubleshooting while maintaining Process Safety Management (PSM) compliance.

University Housing – Columbia, SC

March 2025 – Present

Resident Assistant

- Mentor 28 residents, providing academic and personal support by connecting them to campus resources.
- Plan and execute developmental resident events within a \$350/semester programming budget.
- Enforce housing policy and de-escalate conflicts and emergencies to maintain a safe living environment.
- Selected as a returning RA to train incoming staff, role-playing realistic resident scenarios in live simulations to prepare new RAs for conflict resolution and crisis response.

RESEARCH

Vitamin Cube

February 2025 – November 2025

Presentation Team

- Synthesized and screened multiple biomass-derived sorbents, characterizing CO₂ uptake through controlled adsorption testing to identify the top-performing material.
- Spearheaded research into novel chemical additives for a Solid Direct Air Capture (S-DAC) system, discovering that pyrolyzed mandarin peels treated with KOH successfully captured 6 wt.% CO₂.
- Pitched a comprehensive business model and process scale-up strategy to a panel of industry judges acting as investors, earning 2nd place internationally.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

American Institute of Chemical Engineers (AIChE)

August 2024 – Present

Vice President

- Built the chapter's sponsorship infrastructure from scratch, including a sponsorship tracker and formal sponsorship package, that supported securing over \$5,000 in funding in a semester for the chapter.
- Implemented a delegation system for the executive team and established annual constitutional review as a standing requirement, improving accountability and continuity across leadership transitions.
- Started the organization's LinkedIn page, amassing over 450 followers and cultivating a robust network of club-specific alumni and industry professionals.

SKILLS

Technical: MATLAB, AutoCAD, Python, Excel, Aspen HYSYS, Aspen Plus, DataPARC, VantagePoint

Certifications: Lock Out/ Tag Out (LOTO), Confined Space, General Plant Safety, Hazardous Waste

Languages: English (Native Proficiency), Spanish (Working Proficiency)